

Welcome to the Assignments for Residency 2!

As we see it, this set of eight assignments is designed to meet two objectives:

1. To get you to write formally, so that the comprehensive exam and the eventual dissertation chapters become easier to draft and write.
2. To connect your AIML problem statement to business theories, so that an appropriate theory-based link between business, data and technology can be established.

The Assignments for Module 1 and Module 2 are based on Qualitative and Quantitative Research respectively. As you have gone through courses on these two topics, your course material should be able to provide substance for answering the questions.

The Assignment for Module 3 on Research Writing and Argumentation is on material that should be familiar though your program. Chapters 12 and 13 of Dr. Schipper's book, *The Scholar's Key*, should be relevant and useful.

The Assignments for Module 4 to Module 8 are based on theories that are relevant for the formal study of business administration. Each of these theories have extensive foundational literature and case studies. *It is not expected that you master all of these theories within the contexts of Residency 2.*

You are, of course, free and encouraged to do your own reading and follow your own research processes to respond to the Assignments for Modules 4 to 8. But in case you are looking for a way to cover the ground, we can suggest the following:

- a. For *each* of the specifically mentioned theories (e.g. Modern Portfolio Theory, Efficient Market Hypothesis, and Behavioral Finance in Module 4), generate a 200 to 300-word summary, ideally using a good AI. Include assumptions, implications, current relevance as asked for the in the Assignment. Also include foundational and recent references. Do this separately for each theory. Read the resulting outputs carefully and, of course, search further to validate as needed. If you wish, you can compare and contrast the theories, but that can be an additional step.
- b. The last part of each Assignment asks you to select a theory that most aligns with your own research interest, which is your Specific Problem Statement. For this part, it is best

that you do *not* rely on AI and instead identify one or two aspects of your Specific Problem Statement that align with the framework of *one* of the discussed theories. Write about 400 to 600 words on this. Try to connect a business theory literature reference you have found to an AIML literature reference you had identified earlier. Once done for each of the five Assignments (Modules 4 to 8), this will give you options to build your dissertation's formal foundations on.

During Residency 2, there will be opportunities to discuss what you wrote and make refinements. Remember, the idea is to polish both form (i.e. APA 7) and function (connect business theories to data/technology applications).

Happy reading!

Module 1

Assignment (7-10 Page Paper): Compare and Contrast: Qualitative Research Methodologies

- Define and compare key qualitative research methodologies (e.g., case study, grounded theory, phenomenology).
- Discuss primary reasons for selecting each method in the context of different research problems.
- Analyze strengths, limitations, and use cases.
- Conclude with your preferred qualitative method and justification for its alignment with your scholarly interest

Module 2

Assignment (7–10 Page Paper): Compare and Contrast: Quantitative Research Methodologies

- Define and compare key quantitative research methodologies (e.g., experimental, quasi-experimental, survey research).
- Discuss primary reasons for selecting each method based on research objectives and data needs.
- Analyze their respective strengths, limitations, and application contexts.
- Conclude with your preferred quantitative method and a justification aligned with your scholarly goals.

Module 3

Assignment (7–10 Page Paper): Critical Essay on Research Writing and Argumentation

- Define critical thinking and its role in scholarly writing.
- Identify and analyze at least three common logical fallacies, providing examples of each.
- Discuss how to structure strong, logically sound research arguments.
- Apply writing principles from Chapter 12 to critique and revise a sample doctoral research paper introduction.

Module 4

Assignment (7–10 Page Paper): Compare and Contrast: Financial Theories

- Define and compare two or more significant financial theories (e.g., Modern Portfolio Theory, Efficient Market Hypothesis, Behavioral Finance).
- Analyze the assumptions, implications, and criticisms of each.
- Discuss their relevance in contemporary financial research and practice.

- Conclude with a position on which theory best aligns with your area of research interest and why.

Module 5

Assignment	(7–10	Page	Paper):
Compare and Contrast: Economic Theories			

- Define and compare major economic theories (e.g., Keynesian Economics, Classical Economics, Supply-Side Economics, Behavioral Economics).
- Examine the assumptions, implications, and applicability of each theory.
- Evaluate the relevance of these theories in current global and financial contexts.
- Conclude with a critical assessment of which theory most closely aligns with your scholarly interests or proposed research problem.

Module 6

Assignment	(7–10	Page	Paper):
Compare and Contrast: Accounting Theories			

- Define and compare major accounting theories (e.g., Positive Accounting Theory, Normative Accounting Theory, Agency Theory, Stakeholder Theory).
- Analyze their foundational assumptions, applications, and implications for research.
- Discuss how these theories influence accounting standards, practices, or policy.
- Conclude with your perspective on which theory best supports your future research interests and why.

Module 7

Assignment	(7–10	Page	Paper):
Compare and Contrast: Marketing Theories			

- Define and compare major marketing theories (e.g., Relationship Marketing, Consumer Behavior Theory, Marketing Mix Theory, Service-Dominant Logic).
- Evaluate how each theory addresses key concepts such as value creation, customer engagement, and market segmentation.
- Assess the relevance of these theories in today's digital and global marketing landscape.
- Conclude with your assessment of which theory most strongly aligns with your intended research focus.

Module 8

Assignment (7–10 Page Paper): Compare and Contrast: Management Theories

- Define and compare major management theories (e.g., Scientific Management, Human Relations Theory, Systems Theory, Contingency Theory).
- Analyze their foundational assumptions, managerial implications, and relevance to contemporary organizations.
- Evaluate their integration with leadership, motivation, and organizational performance.
- Conclude by identifying the theory that best aligns with your research interests and doctoral focus.